

INRL20160: The Politics of the EU

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2023-2024



Introduction

This course draws on a range of political science research on European integration and European Union politics to analyse the development of the EU and how it operates today. The course addresses one of the most important questions in the study of European politics and international organisations: Why did a diverse group of states construct what is currently the world's most extensive example of international integration? The course provides an extensive overview of the contemporary EU, including its institutions and policy-making processes using approaches from modern political science. We will assess how the EU is coping with economic and political challenges to its prosperity and legitimacy. By the end of the module, students will have a thorough grounding in EU politics and the manner in which EU institutions function and cooperate to make policy.

Contact details and office hours

If you have any questions about the course, please consult the syllabus before contacting module instructors.

Points of contact with module instructors

- **Email:** Please put the course code (INRL20160) in subject line of all correspondences.

Lecturer - James Cross: james.cross@ucd.ie

Teaching assistant - Lorcan McLaren: lorcan.mclaren@ucdconnect.ie

- **Office hours:** If your question remains unanswered via email, office hours on weeks when lectures take place are available by appointment.

Learning Outcomes

Knowledge and Understanding

Following this course students will develop a range of important transferable skills.

Substantive knowledge

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- Understand and apply the major theories of European integration.
- Understand the contemporary politics of European integration.
- Display knowledge of the objectives and functioning of key EU institutions and policies.
- Critically assess the successes and failures of EU policies.

Skills (Intellectual and Transferable)

The lectures will encourage you to:

- Listen carefully and critically to orally-presented argument
- Develop selective and efficient note-taking methods
- Make links between material presented at different times, on different issues

The written work in the course (policy brief assignment and examination) will require you to:

- Select relevant material from lectures, literature, news sources, and the web
- Understand, analyse and assess that material
- Produce a sustained, structured and informed answer
- Write in a concise and cogent style
- Employ AI tools to improve rather than replace writing skills and outputs

Assessment

Grade component breakdown

- Policy brief assignment and associated peer review tasks - 40%
 - Workshop participation and first draft - 10%
 - Peer reviews - 10%
 - Final submission - 20%
- Final exam - 60%
 - 2x questions answered @ 30% each

Policy brief assignment - 40%

In addition to the end of year exam, you will be required to submit a policy brief assignment. This assignment aims to provide policy professionals with accessible summaries of research papers published on topics relevant to EU politics. Policy Briefs offer short **(no more than 1000 words in main text)** high-level takes on research and its findings from a policy perspective. The intention is to provide a non-expert and time-poor reader with an understanding of the policy context and findings of a piece of research or literature, along with the key policy messages they should take away from it, so that they can hopefully make better use of the research when designing policy. The policy brief assignments are intended to assess your substantive knowledge of European integration and apply the insights you have gained from the course to current issues facing the EU and European integration. The relatively short length of the policy brief means that students must prioritise what they include in their text. They need to think carefully about what elements of their argument need to be developed and what elements can be given less attention.

Assignment timeline:

1. Week 4 - Writing skills lectures
2. October 13th - First draft submitted via Brightspace
3. Week 6-7 - Policy brief workshops
4. October 31st - Peer review assignments released
5. November 7th - Peer review assignment deadline
6. November 14th - Assignment due

Guidelines for writing a policy brief

Keep the following in mind when drafting your policy brief assignment:

1. **Purpose of the Policy Brief:** Your policy brief should convince its readers of the urgency of a specific issue related to EU politics and advocate for a particular course of action or policy recommendation.
2. **Structure of the policy brief:**
 - **Executive Summary:** Begin with a concise summary of your main findings and recommendations.
 - **Context and Importance:** Detail the current situation, the significance of the issue, and why it matters in the context of EU politics.
 - **Critique of Policy Options:** Analyse existing policy options or interventions, highlighting strengths, weaknesses, and gaps.
 - **Policy Recommendations:** Clearly articulate your proposed solutions or actions, backed by empirical evidence, academic research, and clear reasoning.
 - **Bibliography**
 - A full bibliography of works cited is required
 - It does not count towards the word count.
 - **Appendices:**
 - **Appendix 1 (Mandatory):** should provide a full account of the AI tools used to draft the assignment, and a short explanation of how you used them.
 - **Appendix 2 (optional):** can be used to include supplementary information, data, or sources that support your arguments but don't fit in the main body. These should be used sparingly and only include relevant materials.
 - Appendices do not count towards the word count.
3. **Referencing Academic Debates:** Ground your brief in current academic debates and literature. Highlight where your topic fits within these discussions and how it contributes or challenges existing viewpoints.

4. **Clarity and Conciseness:** Your brief should be well-written, clear, and concise. Avoid jargon; make it accessible for individuals who may not be experts in EU politics (like your future boss!).
5. **Evidence-Based:** Support your arguments and recommendations with solid evidence. This could come from academic research, reports, surveys, or expert interviews, and be related to EU politics or the policy issue under discussion.
6. **Audience:** Keep in mind the diverse audience that might read your policy brief. This could range from policymakers, researchers, to the general public interested in EU politics.
7. **Layout and Presentation:** Use clear headings, bullet points, and possibly charts or illustrations to make your brief visually appealing and easy to navigate. Make sure to cite all data sources appropriately.
8. **Feedback and Revision:** Use peer review feedback to improve the final draft and be prepared to revise for clarity, accuracy, and impact. The AI tools discussed below can also be used for feedback and drafting.
9. **Length:** Aim for no more than 1000 words excluding the bibliography and appendices, ensuring that every word counts and contributes to your overall argument and purpose.
10. **Final Check:** Before submission, ensure that you've met all the assignment's requirements, have properly cited all your sources, and included the mandatory appendix on AI use (see submission requirements below).

Use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools

I encourage the use of generative AI tools when completing the assignments for this module, but all work relying on AI generated content must adhere to the highest academic standards. Users of this technology must be aware of what it can and more importantly, what it cannot do well. It is crucial for you to exercise judgement when evaluating the quality and reliability of content generated through AI platforms. AI is not a panacea for all writing challenges; it will not automatically generate a flawless, logically coherent, and factually correct assignment. Instead, use AI as a tool to tackle specific issues such as brainstorming and idea formation, literature discovery, and text drafting issues. View your preferred AI platform(s) as useful but imperfect tools that can offer inspiration, new perspectives, and supplementary areas for research for your own work. In-depth research on your part remains essential to ensure coherent, factual, and scientifically informed perspectives in your assignment. Always cross-reference the information AI offers against other independent and reliable sources.

AI use must be in line with UCD's policies on academic integrity and adhere to the highest academic standards. See here for details: <https://libguides.ucd.ie/academicintegrity>.

Documenting AI use (mandatory)

Since generative AI is such a novel tool in an academic context, we do not yet fully understand what it is capable of and these capabilities are evolving quickly. What was

impossible today might well become trivial tomorrow (keeping in mind the academic standards mentioned above). In order to address this you are expected to provide an account of the tools used and the way in which they were used in a **mandatory appendix** to your assignment. This appendix will be assessed as part of the assignment, with grade points awarded for effective communication of the methods used to generate content. For each instance where a generative AI tool is used, you need to provide:

1. An in-text citation or footnote. For example:
 - “Some AI-generated text (OpenAI 2023)”
2. A bibliographic reference to the tool used and the date of access
3. An entry in the mandatory AI appendix detailing how the tool was used. For example:

AI tool used	Explanation	Prompt used
ChatGPT	Topic brainstorming	“Provide an overview of problems associated with the current EU legislative process.”
ChatGPT	Topic brainstorming	“Provide a set of policy recommendations to address these problems.”
Elicit	Literature search	“Compile a list of academic publications detailing some of the problems with the legislative process of the European Union.”

Table 1: Example table demonstrating how generative AI was use to complete policy brief assignment

Generative AI tools and apps:

Below I have listed some AI tools that might help you complete your policy brief assignment:

- Brainstorming
 - ChatGPT: <https://chat.openai.com>
 - Bing in creative mode (GPT4 for free): www.bing.com
- Literature discovery
 - Elicit: <https://elicit.org>
 - Semantic Scholar: <https://www.semanticscholar.org>
 - Perplexity: <https://www.perplexity.ai>
 - SciSpace: <https://typeset.io>

- Structure and drafting
 - Grammarly: <https://www.grammarly.com>
 - Quillbot: <https://quillbot.com/>
 - Jasper: <https://www.jasper.ai/>
 - Jenni: <https://jenni.ai>

Peer-review process

To aid you in preparing your assignment, we will provide 2 lectures on writing skills and the peer review process. The lectures are aimed at helping you with your assignment and will revolve around the development of a relevant question and framing a concise argument to answer your chosen question. These lectures will be held on **Week 4** at the time of the normal lecture.

After the writing skills lectures, you will be required to submit a **1000 word** first draft of your policy brief. Drafts should be structured according to the guidelines above. The draft should be submitted no later than **5 p.m. on 13th October**.

Following this, writing groups shall be organised in **Week 6-7** so that your idea for the policy brief can be workshopped and developed under the tutorage of the module teaching assistant. You are required to sign up to a workshop date at the start of the module (instructions will be provided in due course).

This draft will then be assessed through blind peer-review and you will receive feedback to help you improve your policy brief before the final submission. On **31st October** each student will be assigned five drafts to provide feedback on. The feedback should be submitted no later than **5 p.m. on 7th November**. Both drafts and feedback will be count towards your final grade.

Final submission

The following guidelines should be adhered to when preparing your final assignment submission:

- The text should be *strictly* under **1000 words**.
- This **word count does not include the bibliography or appendices**.
- Appendix 1 detailing the generative AI tool used and the method of use is required.
- Your policy brief assignment should be submitted no later than **5 p.m. on 14th November**.
- You will be required to submit a **PDF copy of your assignment electronically via Brightspace**. Google how to do this if you do not know how to do so already.
- You will also have to submit a declaration of authorship form via Brightspace, which can be found here: <https://www.ucd.ie/spire/filestore/School%20Declaration%20of%20Authorship%202022.pdf>
- **No hard copy is required.**

A selection of the best policy brief shall be published (with the author's consent) on the Dublin European Institute's blog found at www.europedebate.ie. This widely read and highly visible platform provides the opportunity for students to contribute to the public debate about European integration in a concrete manner to a national and international audience. It also allows students to publicly demonstrate their mastery of their chosen topic in a professional context, and as such represents a great opportunity to build a profile for future employers be they in academia, the public sector or the private sector.

End of year exam - 60%

There will be an exam at the end of the semester. This examination will constitute 60% of your final mark. This will either be an in-person or take-home exam depending on the covid-19 restrictions in place at the time. Example exams demonstrating the structure and requirements of the end of year exam will be distributed in due course.

There will be **6 questions** on the exam and you have to **answer 2** of them.

Course reading

Required readings:

The following texts shall be used extensively throughout the course, so it is recommended that you get access to them.

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2022. European Union Politics. Oxford University Press. 7th ed.
- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. The Political System of the European Union. Palgrave Macmillan. 4th Ed.

NOTE: The Cini and Borragán text is available digitally through the library via the Oxford University Press Politics Trove.

Recommended Readings

The following books provide a general overview of the topics that will be covered in this module.

- Wallace, H., Pollack, M.A. and Young, A.R. eds. 2015. Policy-making in the European Union. Oxford University Press, USA.
- Bomberg, E., Peterson, J. and Corbett, R. 2012. The European Union: how does it work?. Oxford University Press.
- Bache, I., Bulmer, S., George, S. and Parker, O. 2014. Politics in the European Union. Oxford University Press, USA.
- Hix, S. 2013. What's Wrong with the Europe Union and How to Fix it. John Wiley & Sons.

- Majone, G. 2009. Dilemmas of European integration: the ambiguities and pitfalls of integration by stealth. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Peterson, J. and Shackleton, M. 2012. The institutions of the European Union. Oxford University Press.
- Thomson, R. 2011. Resolving controversy in the European Union: legislative decision-making before and after enlargement. Cambridge University Press.
- Wiener, A. and Diez, T. 2009. European integration theory. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

In addition to these readings, students should keep up to date on current European affairs by reading daily newspapers, or one of the many websites devoted to EU politics. This reading is essential as it will allow you to keep up to date with current affairs in the EU and identify potential policy brief topics. These websites include the following:

- <http://www.euobserver.com>
- <http://europa.eu.int>
- <http://www.eupolitics.com>
- <http://www.ft.com>
- <http://blogs.lse.ac.uk/europpblog/>
- <http://blogs.lse.ac.uk/brexit/>

Brightspace

Please make sure you have access to the module in Brightspace as soon as possible. It is the student's responsibility to make sure that they are signed up to the module correctly and they know how to submit coursework through the appropriate Brightspace assignment tab. If you have any issues with Brightspace contact the Brightspace support people to resolve the issue.

Furthermore, module materials such as this syllabus and announcements made outside lectures shall be on Brightspace. As such, Brightspace is an important communication tool for the module.

Detailed course programme

Week 1

Introduction and the history of European integration

Study questions

- What are the major challenges, threats, and opportunities facing the EU today? How do you think these issues will affect the EU and shape its future?
- What are the main milestones that the integration process in Europe went through?

- How has the European integration project developed over time and how has the policy remit of the EU evolved?
- How have global events and geopolitical shifts influenced the EU's objectives and policies?
- What have been the key drivers of enlargement and deeper integration within the EU?
- Can you identify any points in history where the EU could have taken a different developmental path? What might have been the outcomes?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2022. European Union Politics. Oxford University Press. Chapter 1-3.

Further reading

- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. The Political System of the European Union. Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 1.
- Urwin, D.W. 2014. The community of Europe: A history of European integration since 1945. Routledge.
- Dinan, D. 2010. Ever Closer Union: An Introduction to European Integration. London: Palgrave Macmillan. Chapters 1-6.
- Marks, G. 2011. Europe and Its Empires: From Rome to the European Union. Journal of Common Market Studies 50(1), pp.1-20.
- Nugent, N. 2010. The Government and Politics of the European Union. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan, Part 1: Chapters 1-7.
- Bache, I. and George, S. 2011. Politics in the European Union. Oxford: Oxford University Press, Chapters 5-11.
- Diebold, W. 1959. The Schuman Plan. New York: Praeger.
- Dougan, M. 2008. The Treaty of Lisbon 2007: Winning Minds not Hearts. Common Market Law Review 45, pp.617–703.
- Gray, M. and Stubb, A. 2001. Keynote Article: The Treaty of Nice–Negotiating a Poisoned Chalice?. JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies, 39(s1), pp.5-23.
- Magnette, P. and Nicolaidis, K. 2004. The European Convention: bargaining in the shadow of rhetoric. West European Politics, 27(3), pp.381-404.
- Majone, G. 2006. The Common Sense of European Integration. Journal of European Public Policy 13(5), pp.607-626.
- Piris, J-C. 2010. The Lisbon Treaty: a legal and political analysis. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Week 2

Theories of European integration

Study questions

- Describe the main logic behind neofunctionalism as a theory of European integration. Can this theory successfully explain how we got to where we are now in terms of EU integration?
- Describe the main logic behind intergovernmentalism. Does this theory do a better job of explaining the European integration project than neofunctionalism?
- What are the strengths and weaknesses of both theories of integration?
- What are the three different types of institutionalism? How do they differ from one another?
- How do institutionalist theories differ from the ‘grand’ theories of integration that went before?
- How successful are institutionalist theories at explaining EU politics?
- Are there any recent developments or crises in the EU that challenge the premises of these theories?
- How have institutionalist theories evolved to account for the complexities and nuances of modern EU politics?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (eds.) 2022. European Union Politics, Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapters 4-6.
- Moravcsik, A. 1993. Preferences and Power in the European Community. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 31(4), pp.473-524.
- Aspinwall, M. and Schneider, G. 2000. Same Menu, Separate Tables: The Institutional Turn in Political Science and the Study of European Integration. *European Journal of Political Research* 38, pp.1-36.

Further reading

- Hooghe, L., Marks, G., 2019. Grand theories of European integration in the twenty-first century. *Journal of European Public Policy* 26, 1113–1133. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2019.1611111>
- Rauh, C., 2019. Between neo-functionalist optimism and post-functionalist pessimism: Integrating politicisation into integration theory.
- Carstensen, M.B., Schmidt, V.A., 2016. Power through, over and in ideas: conceptualizing ideational power in discursive institutionalism. *Journal of European Public Policy* 23, 318–337. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2015.1115534>

- Hoffmann, S. 1966. Obstinate or obsolete? The fate of the nation-state and the case of Western Europe. *Daedalus*, pp.862-915.
- Haas, E.B. 1976. Turbulent Fields and the Theory of Regional Integration. *International Organization* 30, pp.173-212.
- Monnet, J. 1978. *Memoirs*. New York: Doubleday.
- Bache, I. and George, S. 2011. *Politics in the European Union*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, Chapter 1.
- Haas, E.B. 1958. *The Uniting of Europe*. Stanford: Stanford University Press.
- Haas, E.B. 1961. International Integration: The European and Universal Process. *International Organization* 15(3), pp.366-92.
- Haas, E.B. 1975. *The Obsolescence of Regional Integration Theory*. Berkeley: Institute of International Studies.
- Hooghe, L and Marks G. 2001. *Multi-Level Governance and European Integration*. Oxford: Rowman and Littlefield.
- Jupille, J. and Caporaso, J.A. 1999. Institutionalism and the European Union: Beyond Comparative Politics and International Relations. *Annual Review Political Science* 2, pp.429-44.
- Moravcsik, A. 1998. *The Choice For Europe: Social Purpose And State Power From Messina To Maastricht*. Cornell University Press, Chapter 1, 7.
- Nugent, N. 2010. *The Government and Politics of the European Union*. London: Palgrave Macmillan, Chapter 23.
- Pollack, M.A. 2003. *The Engines of European Integration: Delegation, Agency and Agenda Setting in the EU*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Pollock, M.A. 2005. Theorizing the EU: International Organization, Domestic Polity, or Experiment in New Governance? *Annual Review Political Science*. 8, pp.357-98.
- Rosamond, B. 2000. *Theories of European Integration* London: MacMillan, Chapters 2 and 3.
- Sandholtz, W. And Sweet Stone, A. 1998. *European Integration and Supranational Governance*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Weiner, A. and Diez, T. 2009. *European Integration Theory*. Oxford: Oxford University Press (2nd Edition).
- Hooghe, L. and Marks, G. 2009. A Postfunctionalist Theory of European Integration: From Permissive Consensus to Constraining Dissensus. *British Journal of Political Science* 39(1), pp.1-23.
- Pierson P. 1996., The path to European Integration: An Historical Institutional Perspective. *Comparative Political Studies*. 29(2), pp.123-63.

- Tsebelis, G. and Garrett, G. 2001., The Institutional Foundations of Intergovernmentalism and Supranationalism. *International Organization* 55(2), pp.357-90.
- Bickerton, C.J., Hodson, D. and Puetter, U. 2014. The new intergovernmentalism: European integration in the post-Maastricht era. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 53(4), pp.703-22.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2015a. What's the news in 'new intergovernmentalism'? A critique of Bickerton, Hodson and Puetter. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 53(4), pp.723-30.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2015. Liberal intergovernmentalism and the euro area crisis. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(2), pp.177-195.
- Puetter, U. 2016. The centrality of consensus and deliberation in contemporary EU politics and the new intergovernmentalism. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.601-615.
- Puetter, U. and Fabbrini, S. 2016. Catalysts of integration—the role of core intergovernmental forums in EU politics. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.633-642.
- Kleine, M., and Pollack, M. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism and Its Critics. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1493–1509.
- Moravcsik, A. 2018. Preferences, Power and Institutions in 21st-century Europe. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1648-1674.
- Meunier, S., and Vachudova, M. A. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism, Illiberalism and the Potential Superpower of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1631–1647.
- Hix, S. 2018. When Optimism Fails: Liberal Intergovernmentalism and Citizen Representation. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1595–1613.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism and the Crises of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1578–1594.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2018. European integration (theory) in times of crisis. A comparison of the Euro and Schengen crises, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 25(7), pp.969-989
- Schmidt, V. A. 2018. Rethinking EU Governance: From Old to New Approaches to Who Steers Integration. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1544–1561.
- Naurin, D. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism in the Councils of the EU: A Baseline Theory?. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1526–1543.
- McNamara, K. R. 2018. Authority Under Construction: The European Union in Comparative Political Perspective. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1510–1525.

- Jones, E. 2018. Towards a theory of disintegration, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 25(3), pp.440-451.
- Rauh, C., 2019. Between neo-functionalist optimism and post-functionalist pessimism: Integrating politicisation into integration theory. Working paper.
- Genschel, P. and Jachtenfuchs, M., 2018. From market integration to core state powers: the Eurozone crisis, the refugee crisis and integration theory. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56(1), pp.178-196.

Week 3

Executive politics and writing workshops

Study questions

- How is the European Council structured? What strengths and weaknesses arise from this structure in terms of its ability to influence the direction of the EU?
- How is the European Commission structured? How does it fit into the institutional structure of the EU?
- Does the institutional structure of the Commission help or hinder its ability to make policy?
- What roles do the European Council and Commission play in the political system of the EU? How do their roles differ?
- Explain principle-agent theory. Does this theory successfully describe the sources of Commission power and influence in EU politics?
- How do the European Council and the European Commission collaborate or conflict in setting EU policies?
- How have the roles and powers of these institutions evolved in response to crises or major policy shifts?
- What impact do changes in the leadership of the European Council and Commission have on EU policy direction?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2022. *European Union Politics*. Oxford University Press. Chapters 10, Chapter 11 (part about European Council)
- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. *The political system of the European Union*. Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 2.
- Pollack, M A. 1997. Delegation, Agency, and Agenda Setting in the European Community. *International Organization* 51(1), pp.99–134.

Further reading

- Frieden, J., Walter, S., 2019. Analyzing inter-state negotiations in the Eurozone crisis and beyond. *European Union Politics* 20, 134–151. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116518813450>
- Pircher, B., Farjam, M., 2021. Oppositional voting in the Council of the EU between 2010 and 2019: Evidence for differentiated politicisation. *European Union Politics* 22, 472–494. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165211004754>
- Rauh, C., 2021. One agenda-setter or many? The varying success of policy initiatives by individual Directorates-General of the European Commission 1994–2016. *European Union Politics* 22, 3–24. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520961467>
- Vaznonytė, A., 2020. The rotating Presidency of the Council of the EU–Still an agenda-setter?. *European Union Politics*, 21(3) pp.497–518.
- Hobolt, S.B. and Wratil, C., 2020. Contestation and responsiveness in EU Council deliberations. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 27(3), pp.362–381.
- Rauh, C. 2019. EU politicization and policy initiatives of the European Commission: the case of consumer policy, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 26(3), pp.344–365
- Delreux, T. and Adriaensen, J. eds., 2017. *The Principal Agent Model and the European Union*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Delreux, T. and Adriaensen, J. 2017. Twenty years of principal-agent research in EU politics: how to cope with complexity?. *European Political Science*, pp.1–18.
- Conceição-Heldt, E. 2010. Who controls whom? Dynamics of power delegation and agency losses in EU trade politics. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 48(4), pp.1107–1126.
- Nugent, N. and Rhinard, M. 2016. Is the European Commission Really in Decline?. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*. 54(5), pp.1199–1215.
- Brown, S.A. 2016. The Commission and the Crisis: Chief Loser or Unexpected Winner?. In *The European Commission and Europe’s Democratic Process*, pp.69–78. Palgrave Macmillan UK.
- Bauer, M.W. and Becker S. 2014. The unexpected winner of the crisis: the European Commission’s strengthened role in economic governance. *Journal of European Integration*. 36(3), pp.213–29.
- da Conceição-Heldt, E. 2016. Why the European Commission is not the “unexpected winner” of the Euro crisis: A comment on Bauer and Becker. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(1), pp.95–100.
- Bauer, M.W. and Becker, S. 2016. Absolute Gains Are Still Gains: Why the European Commission Is a Winner of the Crisis, and Unexpectedly So. A Rejoinder to Eugénia da Conceição-Heldt. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(1), pp.101–106.

- Fabbrini, S. and Puetter, U. 2016. Integration without supranationalisation: studying the lead roles of the European Council and the Council in post-Lisbon EU politics. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.481-495.
- Bailer, S. 2014. An Agent Dependent on the EU Member States? The Determinants of the European Commission's Legislative Success in the European Union, *Journal of European Integration*, 36(1), pp.37-53.
- Egeberg, M. 2006. Executive Politics as Usual: Role Behaviour and Conflict Dimensions in the College of European Commissioners. *Journal of European Public Policy* 13(1), pp.1-15.
- Franchino, F. 2009. Experience and the Distribution of Portfolio Payoffs in the European Commission. *European Journal of Political Research* 48(1), pp.1-30.
- Franchino, F. 1999. Delegating Powers in the European Community. *British Journal of Political Science* 34(2), pp.269-93.
- Dinan, D. 2010. *Ever Closer Union: An Introduction to European Integration*. London: Palgrave Macmillan, Chapters 7-8.
- Bunse, S. 2009. *Small States and EU Governance: Leadership through the Council Presidency*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Cini, M. 1996. *The European Commission: Leadership, Organisation and Culture in the EU Administration*. Manchester: Manchester University Press.
- Franchino, F. 2009. Experience and the distribution of portfolio payoffs in the European Commission. *European Journal of Political Research* 48(1), pp.1-30.
- Häge, F.M. 2008. Who Decides in the Council of the European Union? *Journal of Common Market Studies* 46(3), pp.533-58.
- Häge, F.M. 2016. Political attention in the Council of the European Union: A new dataset of working party meetings, 1995-2014. *European Union Politics* 17(4), pp.683-703
- Hayes-Renshaw, F. and Wallace H. 2006. *The Council of Ministers*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Hooghe, L. 1999. Images of Europe: Orientations to European Integration Among Senior Officials of the Commission. *British Journal of Political Science* 29:345-367.
- Hooghe, L. 2002. *The European Commission and the Integration of Europe*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Hooghe, L. 2005. Several Roads Lead to International Norms, But Few via International Socialization: A Case Study of the European Commission. *International Organization* 59: 861-898.
- Rasmussen, A. 2007. Challenging the Commission's Right of Initiative? Conditions for Institutional Change and Stability. *West European Politics* 30(2), pp.244-64.

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Week 4

Policy brief and peer-review preparation

Week 5

Legislative politics

Study questions

- Describe the different legislative procedures used in the EU. How do they differ from one another?
- Describe the internal structure of the Council of Ministers. How are legislative powers and influence distributed between 1) the member states in terms of voting power? and 2) between the different levels of negotiation within the Council?
- Describe the internal structure of the European Parliament. What are the main dimensions of political conflict in the EP? How stable are coalitions between the EP party groups?
- What are some real-world examples where the legislative procedure significantly influenced the outcome of a policy?
- How have changes in the balance of power among EU institutions impacted legislative processes?

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Week 6

Judicial politics and compliance

Study questions

- Describe the structure of the European Court of Justice and the different procedures the ECJ has at its disposal to enforce EU law?
- What role does the European Court of Justice play in the political system of the EU? What powers does it yield and what are the limits of these powers?

- What do we mean by the term ‘judicial activism’? Does the ECJ engage in judicial activism often? How have member states reacted to examples of judicial activism by the ECJ?
- What difficulties might arise when Member States transpose EU laws into national laws?
- We observe significant variation in the levels of compliance with EU law both between Member States and over time. What can explain this variation?
- Why might member states fail to comply with EU legislation? What incentives are involved in compliance and non-compliance?
- How do ECJ decisions interact with national legal systems, and what challenges arise from this interaction?
- How has the role of the ECJ evolved in the context of expanding EU competencies?
- Can you identify any landmark ECJ cases that had a significant impact on EU integration or member state relations?

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Week 7

Elections, referenda, and public opinion

Study questions

- How has public opinion towards the EU changed over time? What explains this variation?
- What different theories have attempted to explain public attitudes towards the EU? Which of these theories is most convincing and why?
- What do we mean when we describe the EP elections as second order in nature? Is this a fair description of EP elections at this point in the history of the EU?
- How do national events or crises impact public opinion about the EU? Can you provide examples?
- How do political parties within member states influence public opinion about the EU?
- Is voter turnout in EP elections indicative of public interest and opinion toward the EU? Why or why not?

Key reading

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Week 8

Reading week

Week 9

Interest representation

Study questions

- What are interest groups and why do we study them in the EU context?

- Describe the different access point through which lobbyists attempt to influence EU policy making. Do the institutional structures of the Commission, EP, and Council aid or hinder lobbyists in their lobbying attempts?
- What different types of factors have been identified as influencing lobbying success in the EU?
- What attempts have been made to regulate EU lobbying? Have these attempts been successful?
- How do interest groups and lobbyists contribute to or challenge the democratic legitimacy of the EU?
- Can you identify any landmark lobbying campaigns that have significantly impacted EU policy?

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Week 10

Brexit

Study questions

- What factors explain the outcome of the Brexit referendum vote?
- What factors explain the outcome of the Brexit negotiations between the UK and the EU?
- How has Ireland, a much small country than the UK, managed to have its views enshrined in the withdrawal agreement?
- How is Brexit (if it goes ahead) likely to affect EU decision-making?
- How have the Brexit negotiations impacted the relationships between EU member states?
- What are the long-term implications of Brexit for the EU's policy agenda?
- How has Brexit influenced public opinion about the EU in both the UK and the remaining member states?

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Week 11

The EU's democratic deficit and EU transparency

Study questions

- What is a democratic deficit? Does the EU suffer from a lack of democratic legitimacy? Should we hold the EU to the same ideals of democratic legitimacy as we do nation states?
- How transparent is the EU? How has this changed over time? Is increasing transparency a potential way in which to make the EU more democratic and legitimate?
- How do the principles and practices of subsidiarity and proportionality relate to the democratic legitimacy of the EU?

- What role do the media and public opinion play in enhancing or undermining the EU's democratic legitimacy?
- Has the EU made significant strides in improving its transparency, and what challenges remain?

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Week 12

Revision and exam preparation